

Moving-In Condition Report & Rights Checklist — Victoria

Get this right on day one — it protects your bond for the entire tenancy.

Correct as at July 2026. General information only, not legal advice.

Section 1 — Before You Sign the Lease

- ☐ ☐ **Confirm the property meets Victoria's rental minimum standards** — since 25 November 2025, all rental properties must meet these standards *before* being advertised. Standards cover **15 categories**: bathrooms, electrical safety, heating, kitchens, laundries, lighting, locks, mould/damp, structural soundness, toilets, ventilation, vermin-proof bins, windows, window coverings, and window covering cord anchors.
- ☐ ☐ **Check for a fixed heater in the main living area** — this is mandatory, and portable heaters generally don't satisfy the requirement.
- ☐ ☐ **Check the kitchen has a working stovetop with at least two burners**, and adequate food preparation space.
- ☐ ☐ **Check bathrooms have hot and cold running water** and a functioning toilet.
- ☐ ☐ **Check window coverings are present in bedrooms and living areas**, and that corded internal blinds/curtains have an anchor installed (mandatory since 1 December 2025 to prevent looped cords).
- ☐ ☐ **Ask when the smoke alarms were last checked** — annual smoke alarm safety checks became mandatory from 25 November 2025, and the landlord/agent should be able to confirm the most recent check date.
- ☐ ☐ **Know your rights if the property doesn't meet minimum standards.** If you haven't moved in yet and the property fails to meet the mandatory standards, you generally have the right to end the agreement before moving in.

Section 2 — The Condition Report Itself

- ☐ ☐ **Request a physical copy of the condition report** if one isn't automatically provided — you're entitled to one, and Victoria offers a free condition report kit (available to order from Consumer Affairs Victoria or purchase at hardware stores) if you need a template.
- ☐ ☐ **Complete your own section of the condition report thoroughly** — go room by room, and don't rely on the agent's version alone.
- ☐ ☐ **Photograph everything**, especially anything already worn, damaged, or imperfect — timestamped photos are your strongest evidence at the end of the tenancy.
- ☐ ☐ **Note existing issues explicitly**: scuff marks, stains, cracked tiles, worn carpet, damaged blinds, anything not in perfect condition — if it's not recorded now, it can be harder to prove it wasn't your doing later.
- ☐ ☐ **Test everything that should work**: taps, toilets, light switches, power points, the stovetop, exhaust fans, and any included appliances.
- ☐ ☐ **Submit your condition report within the required timeframe** — check your specific tenancy agreement for the exact deadline, and don't leave this until later in your tenancy.
- ☐ ☐ **Keep a copy for yourself** — you'll need this exact document again at the end of your lease to compare against the exit condition report.

Section 3 — Ongoing Rights During Your Tenancy

- ☐ ☐ **Know your rent increase protections.** Rent increase notice periods were extended from 60 to 90 days from 25 November 2025 — your landlord must give you this much notice before any increase takes effect.
- ☐ ☐ **Know that no-fault evictions have been banned.** Landlords can no longer end your lease (whether fixed-term or periodic) without providing a specific legal ground for termination.
- ☐ ☐ **Understand urgent repairs.** For genuinely urgent issues (burst pipes, electrical hazards, critical failures), you may be able to arrange repairs yourself (generally up to \$2,500) and seek reimbursement — check current thresholds and eligibility with Consumer Affairs Victoria before doing this.
- ☐ ☐ **Know your gas/electrical safety check rights.** Rental providers must arrange gas and electrical safety checks every two years by a licensed professional — you're entitled to ask when the last check occurred.
- ☐ ☐ **Request repairs in writing.** If the property develops issues that breach minimum standards during your tenancy, put your repair request in writing (email is fine) — this creates a paper trail if you later need to escalate to VCAT.

Section 4 — Red Flags at Move-In

- ☐ ☐ **A condition report with suspiciously few noted issues** on an older or clearly lived-in property — this can indicate the report wasn't done thoroughly, which works against you later.
- ☐ ☐ **Being pressured to sign the lease before receiving the condition report or inspecting the property properly.**
- ☐ ☐ **No visible smoke alarms, or an inability to confirm when they were last checked.**
- ☐ ☐ **Missing fixed heating, non-functioning locks, or window coverings** — these are mandatory minimum standards, not optional extras.

Quick Reference — VIC Minimum Standards & Key Dates

Requirement	Detail
Minimum standards categories	15 categories, mandatory before advertising (since 25 Nov 2025)
Smoke alarm checks	Annual, mandatory since 25 Nov 2025
Gas/electrical safety checks	Every 2 years, licensed professional
Window cord anchors	Mandatory since 1 Dec 2025

Rent increase notice	90 days (extended from 60, effective 25 Nov 2025)
No-fault evictions	Banned — landlord must provide a specific ground

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